

DEMOCRACY MATTERS * DAY8

Democracy Matters

Today's Special Topic: **Bypassing instead of denial**



Civics & Basic Concepts



TODAY +★



**Communication & Social
Media**



Action & Mobilisation



☆☆☆ are the slots per pillar. Everyone collects their own — My DM shows where you stand.

1 • Special Topic

Bypassing — the sprint

30'

2 • The round

Discussion & wind-down

The Learning Loop — Learn it. Keep it. • 3★ per pillar → DM Champion • 6★ → DM Master

SPECIAL TOPIC

Bypassing instead of denial

How to answer misinformation without just contradicting it

Warm-up

5'

Video

5'

Topic

7'

Discussion

5'

Take-away

5'

Why this topic? Before every vote, claims circulate that aren't true. A "that's not true" helps less than you'd think. There is a second way — and a clear line where it becomes unfair.

Sprint

30m

1 — WARM-UP

Phones out



Scan the QR, enter a name — three questions, everyone at once.

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz

Join — if the QR code acts up

Open the beamer view →

Host: starts the game and shows questions, answers, leaderboard

After each question: answer + explanation — the app does that.

Time

5m

2 — VIDEO



What is bypassing?

Mini Philosophy explains the technique in 90 seconds — in English, with subtitles.



Video not playing? Scan the QR or open the link:

facebook.com/reel/1160919765939031

Video: Mini Philosophy, “The Bypassing Technique” (Facebook, 1:29)

Time
5m

2 — VIDEO • THE SHORT VERSION

Bypassing in four sentences

What	Don't contradict — add something true.
How	True fact, same object, opposite direction.
When	Short claims, before minds are made up.
Line	True facts only, said openly — no manipulation.

The video says “don't fact-check” — the study doesn't: a detailed fact-check stays strong.

2 — TOPIC · LIVE EXPERIMENT

An experiment with you

BOTH SLIPS ANSWER THIS FALSE HEADLINE

“Tap water is unhealthy.”

1. The moderator hands out slips: **left** side of the room gets slip **A**, **right** side slip **B**.
 2. Read your slip silently. **Don't show it.**
 3. Show with **1–5 fingers**: would you drink tap water instead of bottled?
- **Next slide: we compare the two sides.**

[Slips to print](#)

The paper tested with a made-up product. The tap-water example is ours.

Time
7m

2 — TOPIC • THE CHECK

Two answers to the same false claim

HEADLINE

"Tap water is unhealthy."

A • CONTRADICTS IT (DENIAL)

"Tap water is **not** unhealthy."

B • LEAVES IT, ADDS A TRUE FACT (BYPASSING)

"Tap water costs a fraction of bottled water and needs no plastic bottle."

Bypassing leaves the false claim standing and puts something **true** on the other side of the scale: same object, opposite direction.

In experiments, after short headlines, it worked **slightly** better than a short denial. A small edge, found repeatedly.

No edge if people already made up their minds while reading. A detailed fact-check stays strong.

2 — TOPIC • WHERE THE LINE IS

Fair or dodging?

EXAMPLE • A REAL CONCERN

“The wolf kills our sheep.”

That is no rumour. Answering with some other upside would be dodging. Acknowledge first, then talk.

EXAMPLE • A TRUE CORE

“Initiatives only make it with forged signatures.”

If there are individual real cases, acknowledge them first. Then correct the generalisation. Pure bypassing looks like whitewashing.

Bypassing adds a **true** claim to a **false** one. Spin makes a legitimate concern disappear.

3 — OPEN DISCUSSION

What do you think?

- 🗨 Where have you seen a denial backfire?
- 🗨 When would bypassing feel manipulative?
- 🗨 Would you use it — and where not?

2:00

▶ Start timer

Time
5m

4 — TAKE-AWAY · BOTTOM LINE ★

“Contradicting misinformation? It’s pointless anyway.”



★ Claim your star now

Your kit for exactly that conversation:



Check first

Is it really false? If it has a true core, acknowledge that first.



A true counterweight

Same object, opposite direction, at least as strong — and it has to be true.



Say it openly

“Do you know this side too?” If that would embarrass you, it’s manipulation.



Otherwise correct

If nothing true speaks against it: explain in detail, not just “not true”.

Bottom line → Master Checklist · Communication star ★ earned

Time

5m

The round

DEMOCRACY MATTERS

Merci!

The Learning Loop — design & concept of the gamified workshop
format



Slides, quiz & star — everything to revisit

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/bypassing.html

FOR THE MODERATOR

Run sheet



Run sheet on
your phone

before **Print** and cut the slips (A left, B right). No slips: read A to the left half while the right half closes their eyes — then the reverse with B.

15:00 (5') **Warm-up** — QR slide, **open the beamer view**, play the 3 questions. The app shows the explanations.

15:05 (5') **Video** — reel from the slide (1:29, English). Blocked? QR or link. Then the four-sentence short version.

15:10 (7') **Topic** — live experiment (slips, read silently, 1–5 fingers), check slide, then “where the line is” as information.

15:17 (5') **Discussion** — open round, no group task. The three questions on the slide are prompts; you don’t need all of them.

15:22 (5') **Take-away** — kit, bottom line onto the Master Checklist, Communication star ★. Never cut. Then buffer, the round.

Details: [docs/runbook-bypassing.md](#) • **To revisit:** [.../content/bypassing.html](#)